

1954, December 28

The following is a faithful transcription of the handwritten and typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

ST. FELIX FRIARY
Huntington, Indiana

Dec 28 - '54

Blessed be God in all His designs.

Mr. James A. Carrico
South Bend, Ind.

God bless you Brother Carrico. God bless you and yours these days - at once, of threatening forbodings and of God's outstanding mercies. I am not at all surprised at the difficulties you have been meeting with in the cause of Ven. Mother Mary of Jesus de Agreda.

If "To know God is to love Him", and if, "To to serve God is to reign with HIM". then who can doubt the same, because of Mary's nearness and dearness and likeness to God that in every care, so outstanding - who can doubt - that the same, knowing and serving her, holds good? Hence we ought to be ready for ought to expect such diabolical opposition, even from sources whence least expected - - . . "Courage is half the battle". Keep it up. "Confidence in God - the soul of courage - is victory assured. Let us foster it in every way and pray for it - always for an increase of faith and confidence and of reverence for God's holy servants and service. How little it is possible for poor mortals to appreciate, this side of heaven! Blessed be God in all His designs!

As much as I have read of your poetic rendition of The Mystical City of God, I have found interesting and inviting. I certainly would like to go through the whole of it.

Dec. 29th

In my condition and in my present circumstances, however, that would be quite out of the question. I started the above last night when a machine of this kind would not be tolerated. Thanks be to God for the experience and, Glory be to God for a decidedly improvement in the outlook.

What follows now will, at first at least be disappointing. its regarding that said-to-be master piece by the acknowledged genius Michelangelo: "The Fall...". For mature minds and for souls perfectly without concupiscence; Well? For my part, I never liked the picture. I have never believed it more than tolerated by the ecclesiastical authorities. At a first glance at the work I would conclude: "It is more work of a genius than that of a saint. In the first place is it historacal, that it should be a masterpiece? I do not think so.

The sacred Historian, (Genesis II), assures us that the very first thing our poor, dear First Parents, Adam & Eve did, after their sin of disobedience, was to make aprons for themselves, - evidently to avoid giving scandal. Here follows the exact description: "...and she took of the fruit thereof, and did eat, and gave to her husband who did eat. 7 And the eyes of them both were opened : and when they perceived themselves to be naked, they sewed together fig leaves, and made themselves aprons."